



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think it's possible to be in love with someone your entire life? Why or why not?
- If you could go back in time and change one event in your life, what would it be?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing, feelings and reactions.
- I can talk about life experiences or explain my opinion about past events.
- I can show I understand someone's feelings or situation.





Let's Explore!

Peter is **at his wit's end***. What can Sally say to make it better?

* When you are "at your wit's end", you don't know what to do about a problem anymore.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Thanks for the drinks, Sally. It's good to go out with a friend who understands you, sometimes. It relieves a lot of the stress I've had lately.
- Sally:** I know the feeling, Peter. I hadn't realized how much I cared for you guys until I left for my trip around the world last year.
- Peter:** You must have missed us a lot!
- Sally:** I certainly did. I met all sorts of interesting people, but after a year I was ready to move on. When I saw you guys at the airport, it felt as if I had never left.
- Peter:** I wish I could have felt the same way about any of my dates! My friend Matt told me about how he started dating again after he had met his old flame by chance at the gym. They're so happy together now.
- Sally:** Better late than never, I suppose. It must happen more often than you think.
- Peter:** You may be right. I just think that love is incomprehensible to me.
- Sally:** It could feel that way sometimes, but I assure you that it can be quite simple as well. I had thought that relationships were hard work until I met several couples for some of my interviews. They showed me how it's possible to love someone your whole life and be happy about it.
- Peter:** So you mean it might not be hopeless?
- Sally:** That's exactly what I mean!
- Peter:** Well, I don't know. I give up!





Let's Practice!

Sally is explaining to Peter that love and relationships don't work the way he thinks they do.

Instructions: Match the phrases from column A to the phrases in column B.

COLUMN A

COLUMN B

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. I met all sorts of interesting people | () hopeless? |
| 2. When I saw you guys at the airport, | () until I met several couples for some of my interviews. |
| 3. I had thought that relationships were hard work | () but after a year i was ready to move on. |
| 4. They showed me how it's possible to love | () someone your whole life and be happy about it. |
| 5. So you mean it might not be | () it felt as if I had never left. |



Let's Practice!

Sally thinks Peter needs to learn how to love.

Instructions: Use the phrases from the Word Bank to correctly complete the paragraph. Write down the missing words. Use capital letters where necessary.

Word Bank

- it can be
- you can find
- It could feel
- You may be
- I had thought

I know love tends to be incomprehensible. _____ that way sometimes, but I promise you that _____ quite simple as well. _____ that relationships were hard work until I myself had my own pretty interesting experiences. You just need to relax and enjoy. _____ too tense. Just loosen yourself, I'm sure _____ someone just for you. It's possible to love someone your whole life and be happy about it.



Extension Activity

A disastrous outing.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about the last time you had a bad experience at a restaurant.
- Write detailed notes about the event (e.g. Where did you go? What did you order?)
- Compile your notes into a complete paragraph about the event.
- Share the paragraph with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I make notes about a past event.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a past event.

☐ ☐

I share my experiences with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **old flame** (expression): used to refer to an ex-girlfriend
e.g. He started dating again after he had met his old flame by chance at the gym.
- **to move on** (verb): to concentrate one's attention or emotions on other matters in recovering from a setback or difficulty
e.g. After a year I was ready to move on.
- **to relieve** (verb): to free from pain, anxiety, or distress
e.g. It relieves a lot of the stress I've had lately.
- **better late than never** (expression): used when it's better for something to happen late than not at all
e.g. Better late than never. You couldn't possibly regret it!
- **incomprehensible** (adjective): impossible to understand
e.g. I just think that love is incomprehensible to me.
- **hopeless** (adjective): desperate and with no hope
e.g. It might look hopeless now, but there must be something you can do!





Learning Points

Expressing an Opinion About Past Events (Simple Past vs Past Perfect)

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

You use the Simple Past to talk about a finished action that happened at a specific time in the past.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*He started dating again after he **had met** his old flame by chance.*

Which event happened *first*? He met his old flame.

Which event happened *later*? He started dating again.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

*I **had thought** that relationships were hard work until I met several couples for some of my interviews.*

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about the action that happened after that prior action in the Past Perfect tense.

Examples:

- *I hadn't realized how much I cared for you guys until I left for my trip around the world last year.*
- *When I saw you guys at the airport, it felt as if I had never left.*





Learning Points

Expressing Understanding Using Modals

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty. You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context. Example: *You **must have missed** us a lot!* Must = it's very likely
Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>It must happen more often than you think.</i>	It's very likely that it happens more often than you think.
<i>You may be right.</i>	It's possible that you are right.
<i>So you mean it might not be hopeless?</i>	It's not likely that it is hopeless.

